

Trading Psychology Cheat Sheet

The 10 most common behavioral mistakes and exactly how to fix each one.

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Most traders do not lose money because they cannot read charts. They lose money because of how they behave under pressure. These are the 10 behavioral patterns that destroy trading accounts — and what to do about each one.

1

Revenge Trading

After a loss, sizing up or taking a low-quality trade to get it back. Fix: Honor your daily max loss. If you hit it, close the platform.

2

FOMO

Chasing a stock that has already moved because you feel like you are missing the opportunity. Fix: Accept that you missed the move. The next setup is always coming.

3

Overtrading

Taking too many trades, often out of boredom. Fix: Require a specific checklist to be met before every entry. No checklist met, no trade.

4

Moving Your Stop

Moving your stop loss further away when the trade goes against you. Fix: The stop was right when you set it. Moving it is how a small loss becomes an account-damaging loss.

5

Averaging Down

Adding to a losing position because the price is cheaper. Fix: Your stop defines when you are wrong. When wrong, you exit — you do not add.

6

Taking Profits Too Early

Exiting winners the moment they are slightly profitable. Fix: Set a target before you enter. Use a partial exit — take some off at target one, trail the rest.

7

Ignoring the Market

Taking aggressive longs while SPY is selling off. Fix: Check the indexes first. Trade with the tide, not against it.

8

No Plan

Entering without a defined entry, stop, and target. Fix: No plan, no trade. All three must be defined before you click.

9

Overconfidence After Wins

Sizing up after a good run. Fix: Keep position size consistent. Your process works at normal size.

10

Not Reviewing

Trading every day without reviewing what is working. Fix: Journal every trade. Review weekly.

BEHAVIORAL SELF-ASSESSMENT — WHICH DO YOU DO?

Check the ones that apply to your trading. Be honest.

- ☐ I have taken a trade immediately after a loss to try to get it back
- ☐ I have chased a stock after it already moved significantly
- ☐ I have taken more than 5 trades in a single day without a clear reason
- ☐ I have moved my stop loss to avoid booking a loss
- ☐ I have added to a losing position
- ☐ I have sold a winner early out of fear it would reverse
- ☐ I have entered a trade without knowing my exact stop and target first
- ☐ I have traded significantly larger size after a winning streak
- ☐ I have gone a full week without reviewing my trades

TST SCORING

0-2 checks: strong discipline. 3-5 checks: focused work needed on those specific areas. 6+ checks: behavioral patterns are likely your primary source of losses — address these before any other skill development.

The full trading psychology module is included in the TST Academy course at topstocktrading.com